ALMA
ALMATY MANAGEMENT UNIVERSITY

APPROVED BY
Director of the Institute of Entrepreneurship
G.Amirova
«12» августа 2026

CODE AND THE NAME OF THE COURSE: SEI2116 Principles of Economics	**ECTS AND HOURS:** 5 ECTS Total hours: 150 Classroom hours: 45 hours Independent work (IWST, IWS): 105 hours	**PREREQUISITES:** N/A **FORMAT OF TRAINING:** offline
LEVEL OF TRAINING: Bachelor degree	**SEMESTER:** 1	**EDUCATIONAL PROGRAM:** «International Business»
INSTRUCTOR: Dmitriy Ogay, MBA, Professor of the Practice	**INSTRUCTOR's CONTACTS:** Email: d.ogay@almau.edu.kz	**TIME AND PLACE OF CLASSES:** According to the schedule

1. Course description

The course introduces students to key concepts of micro- and macroeconomics necessary for understanding the global business environment. It covers principles of supply and demand, market structures, macroeconomic indicators, economic policy, and international trade. Special attention is given to analyzing real-world economic cases in a business context.

Course objective

To understand and analyze key economic and financial concepts, apply mathematical, statistical, and accounting methods to process and interpret data, and assess the impact of international trade, exchange rates, and tax regimes on company operations and financial decision-making in a global environment.

Learning outcomes (LO):

1. Understand Fundamental Economic Principles - Develop knowledge of key concepts in microeconomics (scarcity, supply and demand, consumer choice, production costs) and macroeconomics (GDP, inflation, unemployment, fiscal and monetary policy).
2. Analyze Individual and Aggregate Economic Behavior - Study how households and firms make decisions, and how these decisions interact to form markets, while also understanding how the entire economy operates at the national and global level.
3. Evaluate the Role of Government and Institutions - Understand how government policies (taxation, spending, regulation, monetary policy) influence efficiency, equity, stability, and growth in both micro and macro contexts.
4. Apply Economic Models to Real-World Issues - Use theoretical models and empirical data to analyze real economic problems, such as inflation, recessions, income inequality, international trade, and globalization.
5. Develop Critical Thinking and Policy Assessment Skills - Build the ability to critically assess economic policies, interpret economic indicators, and propose informed solutions for individuals, businesses, and governments.

Teaching methods:

- include lectures, seminars, practical classes and tasks, educational platforms, and case studies.
- Work on projects that require research, analysis and solution of specific economic problems.
- Analysis of economic models at the micro and macroeconomic level and plotting graphs.
- Individual study of the material, completing assignments, preparing for seminars (assessment of various types of assignments will be carried out by Appendices 1,2,3)

Designed by:
MBA, Professor of the Practice _____ **D.Ogay**

Approved by:

EMD director _____ **Zh.Kosbarmakova**

The electronic version of the syllabus and methodological recommendations for studying the course are available via the link and QR:

https://disk.yandex.kz/d/33KuqoL4oTgelg

2.Thematic's plan by weeks

week	Topic/ module	Assessment	LO	Literature	Rating structure
1	Introduction to economics. Microeconomics and macroeconomics.	analysis of the PPF model	LO1	1. pp 3-29.	
2	The Demand and Supply. Market equilibrium.	Model's analysis	LO1 LO2	1. pp 65-79	100% See Appendix 1
3	Microeconomics of Product Markets. Elasticity.	Task	LO2 LO3	1.pp 90-107	100% See Appendix 2
4	Consumer behavior. Theory of consumer behavior	Case-study	LO2 LO5	1.pp 435-448	
5	Firm behavior. Organizing production. Four market models: Perfect competition & Pure monopoly	Case-study	LO2 LO5	1.pp 260-274 1.pp 280-295 1.pp 300-322	100% See Appendix 3
6	Oligopoly & Monopolistic competition.	Task	LO2 LO3	1.pp 329-343 1. pp 347-360	
7	Public goods & externalities.	Case-study	LO3 LO5	1.pp 195-225	100% See Appendix 3
8	Midterm control 1	Multiplechoice test			100%
9	Key concepts of macroeconomics. SNA. Data of macroeconomics.	task	LO1 LO3 LO4	2.pp 18-31 3.pp 3-15,18-28	
10	Measuring the cost-of-living.	case-study	LO2 LO4	3. pp 32-35	100% See Appendix 3
11	Consumption and saving. Consumption's function. MPC & MPS concept's.	analysis of the model	LO2 LO4	3.pp 496-500 4. pp 347-363	
12	Inflation: types, reasons and impact to the economy.	case-study & task	LO2 LO3 LO5	1. pp 373-390 2. pp 252-262 3. pp 417-435	
13	Money market. Functions of money. Monetary aggregates.	case-study	LO3 LO5	3.pp 80-90,547-563 4.pp 441-520	100% See Appendix 3
14	Fiscal Policy and Monetary policy	case-study	LO3 LO6	3.pp 547-563	
15	International economics. Exchage rates		LO3	1. pp 171-184	
	Midterm control 2	Multiplechoice test			100%
16	Final exam	Paper exam			

Teaching philosophy and learning outcomes

Represents the core principles, values and beliefs that underlie a teacher's approach to the educational process.

Expected Learning Outcomes:

-Understanding the methodology for measuring the results of production activities of the national economy and be able to explain the rating of the economy for various indicators.

-To do explain trends in the behavior of consumers and firms in various markets and their motives affecting changes in demand.

-To be able to give an economic assessment of current events in various world markets at the global level.

-Understanding the main causes of rising unemployment and inflation and explaining government decisions that affect changes in their dynamics.

-To be able to explain the imperfection of the market in certain situations and the incentives government intervention.

- Understanding how the economy and financial markets work, as well as trace all the relationships between them.

The objectives that students should strive to achieve in their learning.

1. Understand the basic market structures and how they work, the behavior of consumers and firms in the money market and their motives for consuming and saving

2. Be able to give an economic assessment of events in different markets, industries and at the global level.
3. Conduct positive and normative analysis of specific economic situations.
4. Be able to explain market imperfections and understand the role of government in such situations
5. Understand how the economy and financial markets work and trace all the relationships between them;

4. Course politics

In class ethics

To complete the course you must attend at least 70% of the classroom sessions. Study within the course involves:

Compulsory attendance of classes;
- Activity during classes;
- Preparation for classes, homework;
- Delivery of tasks on time;
- be tolerant, open and friendly;
- Constructively support feedback in all classes;
- be punctual and mandatory.

You must attend

Exam ethics

Unacceptable:
- Omissions for disrespectful reasons;
- Being late and leaving classes (In case of being late, the student is not allowed to attend class, because he disrupts the course of the training session);
- Late delivery of tasks, etc.

If, for any valid reason, you were absent during the control event, you are given the opportunity to take it during the IWST by agreement with the teacher, otherwise you receive "0" points.

The policy of academic conduct and ethics is based on the Code of Corporate Culture, the Student Code of Ethics, and the Internal Regulations of AlmaU.

Information and communication

You should regularly (daily) check your Personal Page in the automated information system Platonus and corporate email (@almau.edu.kz) to receive additional information, tasks or to know about changes in the schedule.

Academic Withdrawal

For systematic violation of the rules of conduct in classes and/or standards of academic honesty, a student may be given an AW grade (administrative withdrawal from the course), equivalent to F (GPA 0). See Academic Policy, paragraph 7.15.

5. Literature

Required Literature:

1. N. Gregory Mankiw, Principles of Microeconomics, 7-Edition USA , 2015, Cengage Learning
2. N.Gregory Mankiw, Principles of Economics, 6-Edition, USA , 2012, South-Western Cengage Learning
3. Mishkin, F.S. The Economics of Money, Banking, and Financial Markets [Текст]: монография / F.S. Mishkin.- 7 th.- Boston, 2005.- 680 p.

Additional Literature:

1. McConnell C., Brue S., Flynn S. Economics: principles, problems and policies, 20th edition, - USA, New York, NY: 2015, McGraw-Hill

2. Academic integrity and AI Syllabus Statement

The University affirms the following principles of academic integrity of AlmaU:

1. Academic integrity is a key value of the University, its educational process and research.
2.The University ensures compliance with clear, fair and objective standards of academic integrity, citation rules.
3. The University is responsible for ensuring mandatory checking for the presence of borrowed material and the use of text with synonymous replacement of words and expressions without changing the meaning (paraphrases), including the use of text translated from another language of all written works of students, regardless of their nature, content and volume, submitted for academic and / or research purposes.
4. The University ensures the responsibility of the student, teachers and staff for their violation of the principles and standards of academic integrity.
5. The University places increased demands on students, teachers and staff within the framework of its system of fair and objective assessment of learning outcomes, work.

6. The University is responsible for the quality of training of personnel in the educational programs of the University, confirmed by its diploma.
7. The University ensures high responsibility of the teacher, instilling the principles and standards of academic honesty.

During their studies, first-year students must adhere to the following principles of academic integrity:
1. Independent work: students must complete all assignments, tests, and projects independently, based on their knowledge and skills. They must avoid plagiarism, unauthorized assistance, and data falsification. If, when checking homework or solving problems, obvious signs of copying other students' solutions are visible, such work will not be assessed for both students who submitted the same solutions with obvious signs of cheating or copying.

2. Citing sources: when using someone else's ideas, texts, or research, the student is required to cite the author and source of information, this is done to acknowledge the contribution of others.

3. Honest behavior during exams, tests, and tests: any form of cheating, using cheat sheets, or any electronic means of reproducing and transmitting information during exams, tests, and tests is strictly prohibited and is a strict violation of the principles of academic integrity.

4. Data Authenticity: When conducting research or analyzing data in group work, students must provide reliable data from relevant sources, avoiding distortion or falsification.

Use of Artificial Intelligence (AI) in the course:
AI can be used for the following types of academic work:
• Automation of calculations or modelling of economic data.
• Helping to understand complex concepts in microeconomics.
• AI can be used to assist in research, but not to complete written assignments automatically
• Practice on tests or through platforms with AI that provide feedback.
Students should not replace their thinking and analysis with artificial intelligence, such as Chat GPT. Using AI to complete assignments or write texts without their participation automatically is considered academic misconduct.

In cases of violation of the principles of academic integrity:
1. Warning and explanation: For the first violation (e.g. unconscious plagiarism), the student may be given a warning.
2. Resubmitting the assignment: (If the violation is not serious, the student may be allowed to resubmit the assignment, considering academic standards).
3. Reduction or cancellation of grade: (A student may have a grade reduction or even cancellation of the grade for an assignment or project if a violation of academic integrity is found).
4. Academic investigation: In cases of serious violations, such as cheating on an exam or systematic plagiarism, an investigation may be conducted, which may result in the revocation of the work, a reduction in the final grade for the course, or even suspension from the course with an F.

Inclusive academic community
AlmaU classrooms are intended as a safe, inclusive space for all of us, regardless of gender, race/ethnicity, religion, socio- economic status, or other factors. AlmaU is committed to providing opportunities to widen and deepen student participation in their learning, and providing equitable support for all students to achieve that learning. As students in this course, you will explore new topics of interest, create and share new understandings, and develop as the scholars and researchers you are always becoming. These things we do together, as a supportive, collegial and collaborative community. Bullying and harassment of any kind will not be tolerated, and if you notice instances of this, or believe you are experiencing this yourself, please let your instructor(s) know.

Student support
In AlmaU, there is a Student Support Center where you can address your questions and request certificates as needed.
The Advising Center provides consultation and assistance in creating an individual educational plan.
Evaluation Policy
The work of students within the course is assessed by the instructor independently in compliance with the principles of academic honesty.

Assessment of the current academic performance includes the students' active participation during classes, homeworks, independent work of students (hereinafter - IWS), as well as different types of controls is done based on a 100-point scale for each work. The final calculation of academic performance in the discipline is summarized as follows

$$Final\ grade = rating \times 0{,}6 + Э \times 0{,}4$$

where:
Э – final exam grade;
Rating is a score/grade that consists of assessments of current academic performance, tests and midterm assessments.
Rating is calculated:

$$rating = \frac{РК_1 + РК_2}{2}$$

where:
$РК_1$ - automatically calculated by the information system average score, equal to the arithmetic mean of academic performance for the first half of the academic period;
$РК_2$ - automatically calculated by the information system average score, equal to the arithmetic mean of academic performance for the second half of the academic period.
The students' academic achievements are assessed in points on a 100-point scale, in a letter system with a digital equivalent (positive grades from "A" to "D", and "unsatisfactory" - "FX" and "F") (Table 1). Also, AlmaU uses such types of assessments as: Incomplete, Withdrawal, Academic Withdrawal.

Table 1. A point-rating letter system for assessing the academic achievements of students with their translation into a traditional grading scale

Letter Grading	Quantitative equivalent	Points (percentage)	Assessment by the traditional system	General description of evaluation criteria
A	4,0	95–100	Excellent	The student has knowledge of the subject in the full scope of the curriculum, understands the discipline deeply enough; demonstrates a high level of knowledge exceeding the volume provided by the syllabus, gives an comprehensive answer
A-	3,67	90–94		The student has knowledge of the subject in the full scope of the curriculum, understands the discipline deeply enough; gives a comprehensive answer
B+	3,33	85–89	Good	The student demonstrates complete, sufficiently substantiated knowledge of the subject, however, the answers did not always highlight the main points, rational calculation methods were not always used; the answers were mostly brief and not always clear.
B	3,0	80–84		
B-	2,67	75–79		
C+	2,33	70–74		
C	2,0	65–69	satisfactory	The student demonstrates sufficient knowledge of the subject, but without the necessary depth and justification; the answers are unclear and without the necessary logical sequence.
C-	1,67	60–64		
D+	1,33	55–59		
D	1,0	50–54		
FX	0		Unsatisfactory	The student demonstrates insufficient knowledge of the subject; positive answers were not given to certain questions.
F (fail)	0	0–24		The student demonstrates a very low level of knowledge of the subject.
P (pass)			pass	Pass/No pass grades are not expressed in points and are not taken into account when calculating the GPA. Credits for a course are counted in the event of receiving a grade of "P".
NP (non-pass)			non-pass	Credits for the course are not counted in the event of receiving an “NP” grade.

Appendix 1: Marking Rubric for analysis of economic models and constructing graphs

Criteria	90-100 (Excellent)	80-89 (Very Good)	70-79 (Good)	50-69 (Satisfactory/Poor)	0-49 (Unsatisfactory/ Insufficient)
Analysis of Economic Models (50%)	The student demonstrates an exceptional understanding of microeconomic models and their application. The analysis is deep, thorough, and free from errors, showing the ability to think critically about economic problems. Models are applied creatively and effectively, with strong connections between theory and practice.	The student demonstrates a strong understanding of economic models, with an ability to explain and apply them to a variety of scenarios. The analysis is detailed and generally accurate, showing a good grasp of how the models function in real-world situations. Theoretical concepts are well-linked to the practical problem at hand	A reasonable understanding of the main economic models is demonstrated. The student can apply models to solve problems, though the analysis may still be somewhat superficial. There are minor errors or gaps in understanding, but the key ideas are mostly correct. The analysis connects theory to practical situations in a basic way	The student shows a basic understanding of economic models but with significant gaps. Some key concepts are either poorly explained or partially misunderstood. There may be an attempt to apply the model, but the analysis lacks depth and contains several inaccuracies	There is a lack of understanding of fundamental microeconomic models (e.g., demand and supply, cost curves). The student fails to identify basic concepts or apply them appropriately to the problem. The analysis may be completely incorrect or irrelevant, with no logical connection between theory and application
Constructing Graphs (50%)	Graphs are flawlessly constructed, with perfect alignment to the analysis. They are clear, well-labeled, and enhance the overall argument. The student uses graphs not just to illustrate points but also to explore deeper insights, making them a critical part of the analysis	Graphs are clear, accurate, and fully aligned with the analysis. All necessary elements are correctly labeled and the visual representation significantly supports the argument. Graphs are well-integrated into the overall analysis and help explain key points effectively	Graphs are generally accurate and aligned with the economic models used in the analysis. Most key elements (labels, axes, equilibrium points) are correctly represented. There may still be some minor issues in the clarity of the graph or its relevance to the analysis	Graphs are present but may be incomplete or contain errors. While some elements (such as labels or axes) are present, they may not be properly aligned with the analysis. Graphs may not fully support the argument or are poorly presented	Graphs are missing or incorrect. The key elements (e.g., axes, labels, equilibrium points) are absent or incorrectly represented. There is no alignment between the graph and the economic model, and the visual representation is unclear or confusing

Appendix 2: Assessing the solution of tasks and group projects

Criteria	90-100 (Excellent)	80-89 (Very Good)	70-79 (Good)	50-69 (Satisfactory/Poor)	0-49 (Unsatisfactory/ Insufficient)
Understanding of Concepts (20%)	Demonstrates an exceptional understanding of all relevant microeconomic theories. The student shows mastery in applying complex models (e.g., market equilibrium, welfare economics) and can critically evaluate them in a variety of contexts	Demonstrates a strong understanding of key microeconomic concepts. Students can clearly explain and relate these concepts to real-world scenarios, using them to solve problems accurately	The student shows a reasonable understanding of microeconomic theories, with some minor gaps. Key concepts like consumer choice theory or market structures are applied to problems with some accuracy	Shows a basic but incomplete understanding of microeconomic concepts. Key ideas are mentioned but not fully explained or connected to the problem	Demonstrates little to no understanding of fundamental microeconomic concepts (e.g., supply and demand, price elasticity). Economic principles are either misapplied or not mentioned at all
Application of Theory (20%)	Theoretical application is flawless, with creative or innovative approaches to problem-solving. The student is capable of using microeconomic tools to draw insightful conclusions and offer well-justified solutions	Theories are correctly applied with few, if any, errors. The student demonstrates insight into how to use models such as supply and demand, cost-benefit analysis, and elasticity to analyze problems effectively	Theoretical frameworks are generally applied correctly to the problems. There may be minor errors or areas where deeper insight is needed, but the core understanding is sound	Some attempt is made to apply microeconomic theories, but the connections are weak or incomplete. The solutions may have significant errors or oversights, but there is evidence of effort	Theoretical knowledge is not applied to solve problems, or there is a complete mismatch between the theory and the problem. Solutions are mostly incorrect or irrelevant to the questions posed
Problem-Solving (20%)	Problems are solved with depth and precision, showing a thorough understanding of the problem's context. The reasoning is sophisticated and explores multiple dimensions of the issue	The problems are solved thoroughly and with a clear method. The reasoning is logical and well-supported, showing an ability to analyze various aspects of the problem deeply	The student uses appropriate methods to solve most of the problems and provides logical reasoning. While some parts of the solution may lack depth, the main issues are addressed	The problems are partially solved, but the methodology may be incorrect or unclear. The reasoning is basic and contains some logical gaps	The student is unable to break down the problem or use appropriate methods for solving it. The answer may contain critical errors and lacks logical reasoning
Group Dynamics (20%)	The group demonstrates exemplary teamwork, with clear roles, strong communication, and a high level of individual	The group functions efficiently, with clear communication and task distribution. Each member makes a	Group members work together effectively, with defined roles. Most members contribute to the	The group demonstrates some coordination, though individual contributions are uneven. The task	Minimal or no group coordination. Team members show little involvement or contribution, with no clear division of

	contribution. The group produces high-quality work as a cohesive unit	valuable contribution, and there is strong evidence of collaboration throughout the project	project, although the level of engagement may vary. Coordination is sufficient to complete the tasks with few difficulties	division is unclear or lacks balance, but the group manages to complete the project with minimal cooperation	tasks. There is no evidence of collaboration, and group roles are unclear
Presentation and Structure (20%)	The project is presented with exceptional clarity and professionalism. The structure is flawless, with well-organized sections and a compelling narrative. Data and visual aids are perfectly integrated into the argument, enhancing the overall presentation	The work is well-organized and presented professionally. Arguments are clear, concise, and supported by appropriate data and visual aids. The overall structure of the project makes it easy to follow, with minimal errors in communication or layout	The project is well-structured and organized, with clear explanations and a logical flow. Data and visual aids are used to support the argument, though there may still be areas for improvement in presentation	The work has a recognizable structure but lacks coherence. The presentation is understandable but may contain unclear or poorly explained sections. Visual aids or data may be missing or incomplete.	The work is disorganized and poorly presented. There is no clear flow or logical structure to the argument. The final presentation of the group project is unclear, with missing data or explanations

Appendix 3: Rubric for Case Studies

Criteria	**90-100 (Excellent)**	**80-89 (Very Good)**	**70-79 (Good)**	**50-69 (Satisfactory/Poor)**	**0-49 (Unsatisfactory/ Insufficient)**
Understanding of Economic Theories (20%)	The student has an exceptional understanding of microeconomic theories, demonstrating mastery of key concepts. Theories are applied with precision, and the student can make connections between different concepts effectively	The student demonstrates a strong grasp of economic theories and concepts, with the ability to explain them in detail. Theories are effectively linked to the case, showing a clear understanding of their practical application	The student shows a solid understanding of key microeconomic concepts and is able to explain relevant theories. There is a good grasp of how economic models apply to real-world scenarios	The student demonstrates a basic understanding of the relevant economic theories but may lack depth. Theories are mentioned but not always well-explained or properly integrated into the analysis	There is little to no understanding of the economic theories relevant to the case study. Key concepts (e.g., supply and demand, market structures) are either not referenced or completely misinterpreted. The student does not demonstrate a basic comprehension of the microeconomic framework.
Application to the Case (20%)	Economic models and theories are applied with great insight and creativity to the case study. The student demonstrates	Theories and models are applied correctly and insightfully to the specific context of the case study. The	Economic theories are appropriately applied to the case, and the connections between theory and practical	There is an attempt to apply economic theory to the case, but the connections are weak or incomplete. The	There is minimal or no attempt to apply economic theories to the specific case. The analysis may be irrelevant or contain major

	advanced skills in applying microeconomic principles to analyze and solve the case problem	student demonstrates a deep understanding of how microeconomic principles influence real-world situations	application are generally correct. There may be minor errors, but the overall analysis is logical.	analysis may include some correct points, but there are notable gaps or misunderstandings	errors. The student/group fails to relate the theory to the practical situation outlined in the case
Analysis and Critical Thinking (20%)	The analysis is deep, insightful, and original. The student critically evaluates different aspects of the case, providing comprehensive and well-supported conclusions. There is evidence of independent thinking and creativity	The analysis is thorough and well-reasoned, with strong critical thinking demonstrated. The student explores multiple perspectives and provides well-supported conclusions	The analysis is thoughtful and generally thorough. The student engages in critical thinking but may miss some opportunities to explore deeper implications or alternative viewpoints	The analysis is basic and lacks depth. While some issues are addressed, the reasoning is often incomplete or based on limited insight. Critical thinking is minimal	The analysis is superficial or absent. The case study lacks any critical insight, and the conclusions are unsupported or incorrect.
Structure and Clarity (20%)	The case study is impeccably structured, with clear, concise, and logical arguments. The presentation is highly professional, and ideas are communicated with clarity and precision	The case study is well-organized and clearly presented, with logical flow and effective communication. Arguments are easy to follow and are supported by clear explanations and examples	The case study is well-structured, with clear sections and logical transitions. Most arguments are presented clearly, although there may still be minor issues in flow or clarity	The case study has a recognizable structure, but there are issues with clarity and organization. Arguments are not always clearly presented, and transitions between sections are weak	The structure is disorganized and lacks coherence. The presentation is unclear, making it difficult to follow the argument. There is poor language use and insufficient explanation of key points.
Data and Evidence (20%)	Data is used flawlessly to support the analysis, with the student demonstrating exceptional skill in interpreting and integrating evidence. The data is relevant and contributes to a deep understanding of the case	Data is integrated well into the analysis, with a strong understanding of how to use evidence to support arguments. The data interpretation is precise, and the student can draw meaningful insights from it	Data is used effectively to support the analysis. The student demonstrates an understanding of how to interpret the data, though there may be room for deeper insight or more precise use of evidence	Some data or evidence is used, but it may not be well-integrated into the analysis. There are minor mistakes in interpretation, and the relevance of the data to the arguments may be unclear	Minimal or no use of data or evidence to support arguments. The case study lacks depth in its analysis of the provided data or fails to include relevant data.

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